



GDD 21

Body Confident

Your body is yours, and it's good

The body-image game for ages 12-15, and the opener of Chapter 4. Teens deepen their understanding of a still-changing body, learn to spot filters and edits, untie their worth from their looks, and care for, not 'fix', the body they have. Seven mechanics, 23 myth-flips, 12 Fact-or-Filter checks, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Your body is yours, and it's good.

Body Confident opens Chapter 4 (ages 12-15) and deepens Puberty Quest (g13) into the issue that dominates early adolescence: body image. Teens learn that their body is still changing on its own timetable, that most of what they compare themselves to is filtered, that their worth isn't their looks, and that caring for a body is different from 'fixing' it to a standard. The register is real, near-peer and private. New v2 build, carrying the v1 "Fact or Filter" idea into the mechanic-embodiment standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g21 · body-confident (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · real / near-peer · private
Thread / topics	A · Body & Growing Up · UNESCO 6.1, 6.3, 6.4
Prerequisite / builds on	c3 (Growing Up Smart capstone) · builds on g13 (Puberty Quest)
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the body-image opener of Chapter 4.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

23

myth-flips

12

Fact-or-Filter

0%

binary taps

Wellbeing-safe by design. The game aims for **body neutrality** (respect your body, untie worth from looks), not just "you're beautiful". It has no diet, weight-loss, calorie or "ideal body" framing; food and movement are framed for health and joy, never punishment. Signs of disordered eating or persistent body distress route firmly to a trusted adult, school counsellor or doctor.

The age the mirror gets loud.

From the Chapter 4 personas. At 12-15, filtered feeds, comparison and (in India) fair-skin pressure hit hard, and it isn't only girls; boys feel it too.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Riya, 15 (filters, comparison, fair-skin pressure)	To see filters for what they are and untie worth from looks.	spot + strike-rewrite : Fact or Filter; flip colourism.
Veer, 14 (male body image, muscles/height)	To know body pressure hits boys too, and opt out.	strike-rewrite : "real men" myth busted.
The Counsellor	A clear route when body worries get heavy.	branch + role-play : reach out.
Every teen	A kinder, steadier relationship with their body.	reflect + build : care, not 'fix'.

Why this works (the evidence). Edited and filtered images set unrealistic standards, and nearly half of teens say online images make them feel worse about their looks, but knowing images are filtered (media literacy) is protective for body satisfaction, so the game trains that skill directly. Body pressure hits all genders (girls more around slimness and skin tone, boys more around muscularity and height), so worth is untied from appearance throughout. In India, colourism and fair-skin pressure are specific, real harms, named and flipped here. Persistent distress or disordered eating is routed to a trusted adult, counsellor or doctor.

Seven moves, led by the flip.

Body image is largely myth-driven, so **strike-rewrite** leads (the UN/RE engine), with the iconic **spot** "Fact or Filter" media-literacy check, the protective skill, close behind. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite (myth-flip) signature	Flips a body/beauty myth ("fair is better" → every tone is good).	Conceptual change.	23
reflect	Considers worth beyond looks, the inner critic, body gratitude.	Self-worth; body neutrality.	14
sort	Sorts real vs filtered; care vs 'fix'; health vs beauty-myth.	Judgement.	13
spot (Fact or Filter)	Spots the edit, filter, colourism or male-pressure in media.	Media literacy (protective).	12
branch	Chooses to step away from a spiral, or reach for help.	Acting for wellbeing.	9
role-play (voice)	Sets a boundary on body comments; asks for help.	Assertion; help-seeking.	7
build	Builds a feed clean-up, a care routine, a kinder inner voice.	Skills, by hand.	6

23 myths flipped, 12 Fact-or-Filter checks, 16 branch/role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Body Confident plays like a media-detective game with a self-care heart: you scan glossy selfies, ads and reels for the edits in "Fact or Filter", call out the colourism or "no abs, no respect" pressure hiding inside, then flip the myth to something true and kind. It's a little cathartic and a little cheeky, exposing the manufactured "perfect", which is exactly what makes the steadier message land.

Is it teaching?

Yes, body-image media literacy and body neutrality: that bodies change on their own timetable, that most images are edited, that worth isn't appearance, that beauty "ideals" (including colourism and male muscularity) are invented, and that caring for a body is not 'fixing' it.

The belief it moves. From "my worth is my looks; everyone online looks perfect; fairer/thinner/more-muscular is better; I must 'fix' my body" → "my body is mine, changing and good; most of what I compare to is filtered; I'm more than my looks; I care for my body, I don't 'fix' it."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the body → filters → worth → myths → care → help arc, grounded in verified evidence and India context. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Your still-changing body	14	strike-rewrite, sort, build	Puberty depth, timing diversity, periods & dignity, acne.
Real vs filtered	13	spot, sort, strike-rewrite	Fact or Filter; comparison trap; curating the feed.
Worth isn't looks	14	strike-rewrite, reflect, role-play	Body neutrality; inner critic; you're more than a body.
Bust the beauty myths	16	strike-rewrite, sort, spot	Ideal body, colourism/fair-skin, "real men", thin-ideal.
Care, don't 'fix'	12	sort, build, branch	Sleep, food & movement for health/joy; risky-trend safety.
When it gets heavy	15	branch, role-play, reflect	Spiral & disordered-eating signs; reaching a trusted adult.

A Fact-or-Filter spot + a colourism flip, verbatim.

```
spot: "Fact or Filter: a glowing 'flawless' selfie. Spot the edits."
      - skin smoothed to have zero pores           [filter]
      - jaw and waist subtly reshaped              [filter]
      why: "'Flawless' selfies are usually filtered; real skin has texture."

flip: "Fairer skin is more beautiful."
      UN -> "Fair skin is more beautiful or better."
      RE -> "Every skin tone is beautiful; 'fair is better' is a harmful myth."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 21 Body Confident — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
My worth depends on how I look.	Your worth comes from who you are, not your appearance.	Body neutrality.
Fairer skin is more beautiful.	Every skin tone is beautiful; "fair is better" is a harmful myth.	Colourism (India).
Real men are big and muscular.	Bodies of every build are fine; manhood isn't a body type.	Male body image.
Thin always means healthy and beautiful.	Health and beauty come in many shapes; thinness measures neither.	Beauty myths.
If I had that filter's face, I'd be happy.	The filter isn't real, and happiness isn't a face or a waistline.	Comparison.
Skipping meals is a smart way to look better.	Skipping meals harms your health and mood; your body needs fuel.	Eating safeguarding.
Boys don't get body image problems.	Boys face real body pressure too; it's okay to talk about it.	De-stigmatise.
There's one ideal body to aim for.	There is no one ideal body; healthy bodies come in huge variety.	Beauty myths.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "something about this 'perfect' photo is off, can you spot it?".
2. **Play.** Spot the filter (Fact or Filter), flip a body myth, or sort care vs 'fix', rotated.
3. **The flip.** On a myth, UN strikes it and RE writes the kind truth ("fair is better" → every tone is good).
4. **Apply.** Curate a feed, set a boundary on body comments, or build a care routine.
5. **Route to help.** Heavy body thoughts or eating signs surface a trusted adult, counsellor or doctor.
6. **Sticker.** The Body-Confident badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **Fact-or-Filter scanner** and the **myth-flip card**, expose the edit, then rewrite the standard. The media-literacy engine is shared with Smart Screen Heroes (g12) and the gender thread; the body-neutrality framing seeds later wellbeing nodes.

Real, private, body-safe.

- **Register.** Ages 12-15, real and near-peer; Lensy is matter-of-fact, never preachy, never body-shaming.
- **Body neutrality, not just positivity.** The aim is respect and worth-beyond-looks, you don't have to love every inch.
- **No diet culture.** Zero weight-loss, calorie, "ideal body" or "earn/burn food" framing; food and movement are for health and joy.
- **Eating safeguarding.** Skipping meals or over-exercising to change the body are framed as signs to get help, never as tips.
- **All genders.** Male body image (Veer) is given real space; colourism is named for the India-specific harm it is.
- **Route to help.** Persistent distress or disordered eating routes to a trusted adult, school counsellor or doctor.
- **Access.** Audio-first, private/solo, offline; India-grounded; pairs with Puberty Quest (g13) and Smart Screen Heroes (g12).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. body-confident** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; **strike-rewrite** leads, with the **spot** Fact-or-Filter renderer (scene + trick flags + why) doing the media-literacy work.
- **Fact-checked content.** Body-image, filter and colourism claims verified against current evidence; flag medical/help-resource edits for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, strike-rewrite at 27%, 0% binary, 16 autonomy, 23 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Body-distress routing surfaced via the shared "get help" component (trusted adult / counsellor / doctor).
- **Tracked.** sync_master_tracker.py marks g21 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.
- **Generated path.** Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Safety contracts (never traded for engagement): body neutrality not diet culture; no "ideal body"; food/movement for health not punishment; eating-distress always routes to help; all genders; colourism named; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Media literacy is the protective skill.** Because teens who know images are filtered report greater body satisfaction, training the "Fact or Filter" eye is the single most evidence-backed move the game can make, so it is built in as a lead mechanic.
- **Untie worth from looks (body neutrality).** Since appearance pressure spans genders and chasing an "ideal" is a losing game, the durable fix is shifting worth off looks entirely, which the worth-not-looks and beauty-myth categories do directly.
- **Name the India-specific harms, and route distress.** Colourism and fair-skin pressure are real adolescent harms in India, named and flipped here, and because body image links to disordered eating, every heavy path leads to a trusted adult, counsellor or doctor.

Sources: adolescent body image & social-media/filters evidence (media-literacy as protective); colourism as an adolescent health concern (India); National Alliance for Eating Disorders (help-resource guidance). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 24 games now v2. Next in Chapter 4: Bounce (g39, resilience) and Plan It (g22).